Jillo Woche

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Summary

Senior Frontend Engineer with 6+ years building production web applications with React and TypeScript across FinTech, Web3 and enterprise SaaS. Experienced owning complex frontend features end-to-end, building reusable design systems, integrating with APIs, and delivering secure, accessible and well-tested user experiences. Strong full-stack background with Node.js and PostgreSQL, with experience working across distributed remote teams.

Experience

Senior Frontend Engineer

Rainforest Alliance • Nairobi, Kenya 10/2025 - Present

- Led frontend architecture decisions across React, TypeScript, TanStack Query, authentication flows, application state management, and reusable component architecture.
- Designed and maintained a reusable frontend design system using Storybook and Figma-derived design tokens, with shared components distributed through an internal NPM package for consumption across applications.
- Collaborated closely with product, design, and backend engineers on API contracts, authentication, access control, and frontend-backend integration, delivering reliable and accessible user experiences.
- Improved platform accessibility and performance through reusable component patterns and testing standards, delivering a faster, more reliable experience for certification users while reducing regression risk.
- Contributed to hiring, technical assessments, code reviews, and engineering standards while mentoring fellow frontend engineers.

Full Stack Software Engineer

GasHawk • EMEA, remote 04/2024 - 08/2025

- Led the end-to-end redevelopment of a Web3 transaction platform using React, TypeScript, Node.js and PostgreSQL, owning frontend architecture, APIs, authentication and transaction workflows.
- Built resilient transaction experiences handling asynchronous transaction states, API failures and real-time status updates, giving users clear feedback throughout money-movement workflows.
- Collaborated with product stakeholders to translate business requirements into scalable technical solutions while maintaining a high standard of code quality and testing.

Full Stack Software Engineer

IOTA • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2023 - 04/2024

- Built backend systems to automate the exchange of SPS documents between IOTA and partners, reducing manual steps and improving process reliability.
- Revamped the TLIP web app frontend with React and TypeScript, enhancing usability and delivering a smoother, more responsive user experience.

Full Stack Software Engineer

Syndicate • EMEA, remote 04/2021 - 03/2023

- Built and deployed a production-ready Web3 dApp in under 3 months (TypeScript, React, Ethereum/Polygon), accelerating Syndicate's go-to market timeline.
- Launched Collectives, enabling NFT-based communities to organize around generative art and driving early engagement among creators and collectors.
- Designed and delivered a GraphQL backend for storing off-chain data in just one month, improving data accessibility and reducing integration complexity.

- Increased smart contract reliability by implementing a comprehensive automated testing suite, reducing the risk of regressions and strengthening security.

Frontend Engineer

Cellulant • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2019 - 03/2021

- Redesigned production payment flows using React/Next.js, improving accessibility and reducing friction across checkout and transaction experiences.
- Optimized checkout UX across 6+ payment methods including mobile money and card payments, designing clear user states around payment selection and transaction completion.

Full-Stack Software Engineer

Andela Kenya Ltd • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2018 - 09/2019

- Delivered multiple customer-facing React applications on rapid sprint cycles, improving user experience while enabling faster delivery of product enhancements.
- Developed and deployed a REST API with Python/Django that supported scalable data handling and reduced backend response times under production load.

Team Leader

Sama • Nairobi, Kenya 06/2016 - 11/2018

- Led a 22-person team in executing a large-scale web crawling project for Glassdoor.
- Coordinated workflows, evaluated team performance, and delivered constructive feedback that improved accuracy and efficiency.

Quality Analyst

Sama • Nairobi, Kenya 11/2015 - 05/2016

- Improved quality across multiple work streams by analyzing compliance gaps and recommending corrective actions.
- Boosted agent performance by assessing transactions, giving feedback, and driving measurable quality gains.
- Delivered clear quality reports to managers and stakeholders, ensuring consistent performance standards.

Agent Junior Developer

Sama • Nairobi, Kenya 07/2015 - 11/2015

- Optimized job feed integrations with HTML, CSS, XPaths, and regex.
- Streamlined error handling by resolving issues and improving data quality.
- Ensured accuracy at scale by verifying data and removing duplication.

Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript(ECMAScript ES2023 / ES2022), SQL, Python

Frontend: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, Vite, TanStack Query, TanStack Router, Zustand, Redux, HTML5, CSS/SCSS, Responsive Design.

Design systems & UI: Storybook, Design Tokens, Component Architecture, Accessibility (WCAG 2.1), Figma collaboration.

Frontend Security: Authentication & Authorization, CSRF Protection, Content Security Policy (CSP), CORS, secure client-side data handling.

Backend & APIs: Node.js, Express, REST, GraphQL, WebSockets, PostgreSQL, Authentication & Authorization.

Databases & Infrastructure: PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Cloud deployments, Azure DevOps, CI/CD.

Web3 & FinTech: ethers.js, Wagmi, WalletConnect, RainbowKit, MetaMask, Ethereum, Polygon

Testing & Tooling: Vitest, Jest, React Testing Library, Playwright.

DevOps: GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Docker, CI/CD.

Links

- Website: **https://jillowoche.dev**
- LinkedIn: **https://linkedin.com/in/jilloabdullahi**
- Github: **https://github.com/jillo-abdullahi**

Education

Information Technology

Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology, • Nairobi, Kenya 01/2015

Graduated with First Class Honors.

References

Available upon request.